



King County Library System

Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes

Burien Library | September 17, 2025, 5pm

Present

KCLS Board

Crystal Goodwin
Jeff Guddat
Harish Kulkarni
Lalita Uppala*
Laura Valenziano

KCLS Staff

Maria Bassett
Jen Baxter
Angie Benedetti
Heidi Daniel
Lisa Fraser
Chase Gallagher
Angie Miraflor
Danielle Perry
Cecie Streitman
Lisa Yamasaki
Donna Zirkle

*Attended remotely

Motions Approved

1. Board Meeting agenda
2. July 30, 2025 Board meeting minutes
3. Payroll expenditures
4. General Fund expenditures

Call to Order

President Laura Valenziano called the meeting to order at 5:08pm. Harish Kulkarni, Jeff Guddat, and Crystal Goodwin attended in person; Lalita Uppala attended remotely. There was a quorum.

Approval of Agenda

Jeff Guddat moved approval of the Board Meeting agenda. Harish Kulkarni seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.

Approval of Board Minutes

Lalita Uppala moved approval of the July 30, 2025 Board Meeting minutes. Jeff Guddat seconded the motion. All voted in favor and the motion passed unanimously.

Public Forum

There was no public comment.

Finance and Facilities Report

Finance and Facilities Director Donna Zirkle presented the monthly Finance report as of the end of July 2025. August and September financials will be presented together at the October meeting. Year-to-date (YTD) revenues were \$82.7M, against the yearly revenue budget of \$150.6M, which was approximately 55%. YTD expenses were \$85.3M, which is 52% of the total expense budget of \$164.6M. CIP expenses YTD at the end of July were \$2.5M, accounting for 20% of the total budget of \$12.5M.

Revenue and expenses are on track, with investment interest remaining strong. Most CIP projects continue to be in the planning phase during the summer months so KCLS can focus on Summer Reading programs and events. One ongoing project of note is the systemwide refresh of the wooden children's chairs with artistic cutouts, which are being refinished.



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Approval of Monthly Expenditures

Crystal Goodwin moved approval of Payroll expenditures for July in the amount of \$3,561,807.75:

(7/03) Ck#00202445-00202463; 972605147-972606306; (7/18) Ck#00202464-00202476; 981769415-981770535. **Jeff Guddat seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.**

Harish Kulkarni moved approval of General Fund #0010 expenditures for July in the amount of

\$7,136,256.54: Travel Advances – Ck#1551-1552; (7/10) Ck#1160772-1160881; 5015614-5015615 (7/17)

Ck#1160882-1161038; 5015616-5015619 (7/18) Ck#1161039-1161050; (7/23) Ck#1161051-1161057

(7/24) Ck#1161058-1161181; 5015620-5015667; (7/25) Ck#1161182-1161184; (7/31) Ck#1161185-

1161297; 5015668-5015671 (8/07) Ck#1161298-1161414; 5015672-5015673; Void: Ck#1160965. **Lalita**

Uppala seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.

Staff and Director's Reports

Olympic Region Report

Olympic Regional Manager Mary Sue Houser was joined by Library Information and Services Managers Denise Feil and Steven Bailey to present an overview of the Olympic Region. Mary Sue began the presentation by introducing the Olympic management team, several of whom were in attendance.

The region includes six locations: Burien, Boulevard Park, Tukwila, Vashon, White Center and Greenbridge. Steven discussed the region's demographics and patron-use statistics. He also outlined the region's diversity, equity and inclusion (DEI) focus areas, which include connecting with and improving service for:

- Latinx/Hispanic and Spanish-speaking communities
- Recent arrivals to the United States
- People experiencing housing and food insecurity

The region follows the four service directions established by the Library Outreach, Programs and Services leadership team. Denise and Steven shared examples of how the region is fulfilling those directions:

- Making Meaningful Connections: Vashon Strawberry Festival, White Center Pride and the Tukwila Community Roundtable
 - Student Success and Lifelong Learning: English language learning classes, Talk Time conversation practice and Study Zone
 - Engaging with Books and Reading: Summer Reading, story times in English, Spanish and Vietnamese, and the Vashon StoryWalk
 - Obtaining Trustworthy Information: Monthly resource fairs, tax assistance and a partnership with WorkSource
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Central Sorter Replacement Update

Executive Director Heidi Daniel and Collections Management Services Director Jen Baxter provided an update on the Central Sorter Replacement project. The presentation included an overview of the refined design, comparisons of the original and updated schematics, and key details about the new sorter and project timeline.

In late spring, staff met with the manufacturer to reevaluate the initial proposal and identify needed adjustments. The original design had been built for peak capacity, but the revised version has been right sized to align with current operational needs. Key changes include variable delivery lane lengths and capacity calibrated to current circulation levels, rather than assuming peak levels at all times.

Two images were presented to illustrate the design evolution. The first showed the originally proposed model, while the second depicted the newly redesigned version. The updated schematic highlighted the refined configuration, including adjustments to lane lengths and capacity alignment, to better support current and projected operations.

The current sorter's frequent breakdowns have disrupted workflow. The new sorter's modular design is expected to provide greater reliability and ease of maintenance. The updated system will feature multiple delivery lanes, including high-capacity options, and will replace the existing fixed-loop design with a vertical cage. The new sorter is designed to meet current operational demands, and to allow additional capacity to be added if needed in the future.

The design has been finalized, and manufacturing is now underway. Real estate planning and negotiations are continuing. The project is scheduled to go live in the first quarter of 2026.

Heidi also introduced a brief video called *Life of a Book* which showed how a book currently moves through the KCLS system.

KCLS Foundation Update

Foundation Executive Director Lisa Yamasaki introduced a new campaign designed to strengthen community engagement and highlight the Library System's impact in communities. Goals include sparking community involvement, increasing Foundation visibility, supporting the upcoming levy lid lift and sharing KCLS' value through accessible, evergreen and low-cost messaging.

The "Love Letters to Libraries" initiative invites community members to express what they love about their local library by writing, drawing or creating poems in any language. Submissions will celebrate the role KCLS plays in the lives of patrons across the system.



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The campaign will feature 75 to 100 collection boxes at libraries, Mobile Services locations, schools and local businesses. Templates will include an optional name and email section, and signage will be available in multiple languages. Participants may also call in or submit letters online.

The Foundation aims to collect about 3,000 letters, earn at least two media features and display the submissions at the 2026 Literary Lions Gala.

Director's Report

Heidi Daniel discussed two Sound Cities events that she attended in early September. One, for city managers, was held at the Renton Library and focused on opportunities for collaboration. The other, for the group's Public Issues Committee, took place at the Mercer Island Community Center. At that meeting, Heidi gave a presentation on a potential levy lid lift and budget forecasting, and gathered feedback on what committee members believe their constituents want from the Library System.

Heidi also highlighted several events mentioned in her written director's report, including the Fiestas program, and a July roundtable with U.S. Rep. Kim Schrier to discuss Institute of Museum and Library Services funding cuts.

She concluded her presentation with a review of dashboard metrics, focusing on household market penetration — the percentage of households with at least one active library cardholder. The current rate is about 45%, but Heidi would like to see KCLS reach 50%. Physical and digital circulation numbers are approaching a 50-50 split; she expects digital circulation to surpass physical next year.

Board Committee Reports

There were no committee reports.

Trustees Reports

Trustee Jeff Guddat talked about co-presenting with Heidi at the King County Council in late August. This was KCLS' annual report, and it went very well.

Executive Session

At 6:19pm President Laura Valenziano announced that the Board would convene in Executive Session per RCW 42.30.110, Section 1(g), for the review of a public employee. She announced that they would return at 7:00pm. She announced that there would be no further action taken by the Board upon its return.

At 7:05pm Laura Valenziano extended the session to 7:15pm.



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Reconvene Regular Session

At 7:15pm Laura Valenziano reconvened the regular session.

Adjournment

Laura Valenziano adjourned the meeting at 7:15pm.

Laura Valenziano, President

Jeff Guddat, Secretary
